Claims Payment Policy

Subject: Modifier CT

Application: Medicare Advantage Products
Policy number: CP2015012
Related policies: Common CPT and HCPCS Modifiers

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Overview

The Centers for Medicare & Medicaid Services (CMS) has directed providers to use *modifier CT* to report computed tomography (CT) services furnished on equipment that is not consistent with dose optimization standards established by the National Electrical Manufacturers Association (NEMA). Enforcement of NEMA Standard XR 29-2013, also known as the MITA Smart Dose standard, for the Medicare Program is required by the Protecting Access to Medicare Act of 2014.

The criteria of NEMA Standard XR 29-2013 ensure use of the lowest radiation dose necessary to get the image quality needed by providers to make a proper diagnosis. The standard outlines four attributes CT equipment should meet to ensure that a patient receives the highest standard of care as established by professional societies and regulatory agencies. Performing CT services on equipment that meets all elements of the standard helps reduce a patient's lifetime exposure to potentially cancer-causing medical radiation.

Humana works to reduce our members' exposure to medical radiation. Directly and through vendor partnerships, we educate our members on the risks of medical radiation exposure and encourage our in-network providers to provide high quality advanced diagnostic services that meet a broad set of industry standards, including NEMA Standard XR 29-2013.

This policy outlines Humana's billing requirements and reimbursement for services reported with *modifier CT*.

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In addition to the policy, claims payments are subject to other plan requirements for the processing and payment of claims, including, but not limited to, requirements of medical necessity and reasonableness and applicable referral or authorization requirements.

Humana requires providers to follow the appropriate Medicare Program guidance for correct coding using *modifier CT*. Providers must report *modifier CT* with procedure codes for *applicable CT services* performed on equipment that does not meet all four attributes of NEMA Standard XR 29-2013. Humana reduces reimbursement for the *technical component* (*TC)* of an *applicable CT service* reported with *modifier CT* by five percent for dates of service in 2016 and by 15 percent for dates of service beginning January 1, 2017.

Note: Pre-authorization requirements may apply when *applicable CT services* are provided to a Humana member.

Definitions of *Italicized* Terms

- ***Applicable CT services***: Computed tomography services identified by the Centers for Medicare & Medicaid Services (CMS) as subject to the modifier CT payment reduction rule.
- ***Modifier CT***: Computed tomography services furnished using equipment that does not meet each of the attributes of the National Electrical Manufacturers Association (NEMA) XR-29-2013 standard.
- ***Technical component (TC)***: The technical component of a service is for all non-physician work and includes administrative, personnel and capital (equipment and facility) costs and related malpractice expenses. Modifier TC is used with the billing code to indicate that the TC is being billed.

References

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- Centers for Medicare & Medicaid Services website. Transmittal 3402, Change Request 9250. Payment Reduction for Computed Tomography (CT) Diagnostic Imaging Services. www.cms.gov.
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- Centers for Medicare & Medicaid Services HCPCS Level II and associated publications and services.
- Palmetto GBA website. Jurisdiction M MAC. HCPCS Modifier CT. www.palmettogba.com.
- Food and Drug Administration website. Initiative to Reduce Unnecessary Radiation Exposure from Medical Imaging. www.fda.gov.
- American College of Radiology website. NEMA XR-29 (MITA Smart Dose) Standard: Frequently Asked Questions. www.acr.org.
- American Medical Association's CPT® and associated publications and services.

General Humana Resources

- Availity – Providers can register for access to information on a variety of topics such as eligibility, benefits, referrals, authorizations, claims and electronic remittances.
- Claims processing edit notifications – Alerts of upcoming claims payment changes are posted on the first Friday of each month.
- Claims resources – Providers can find information on referrals, authorizations, electronic claim submissions and more.
- Making it easier – This page contains an educational series for providers and healthcare professionals.

- Medical and pharmacy coverage policies – Humana publishes determinations of coverage of medical procedures, devices and medications for the treatment of various conditions. There may be variances in coverage among plans.
- Publications – This page can help you find our quarterly newsletter, provider manual and other resources to help you do business with us.

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